

100 Days of Linux - Day 084

Title: Making Environment Variables Permanent

Today's Goal

Learn how to save environment variables permanently using shell configuration files.

Why This Matters

Permanent environment variables ensure your development tools, scripts and applications work correctly every time you open a new terminal.

Commands of the Day

Syntax:

```
nano ~/.bashrc
export PROJECT=linux
source ~/.bashrc
printenv PROJECT
```

Examples:

```
echo 'export EDITOR=nano' >> ~/.bashrc
source ~/.bashrc
```

Beginner Lesson

Variables created with `export` disappear when the terminal closes. To keep them permanently, add the `export` command to your `~/.bashrc` file and reload it using `source ~/.bashrc`.

Practice Questions

1. Open the `.bashrc` file using `nano`.
2. Add an exported variable named `PROJECT` with the value `linux`.
3. Reload the configuration using `source ~/.bashrc`.
4. Verify the `PROJECT` variable using `printenv`.
5. Display the `PROJECT` variable using `echo`.

Hints

Remember that `'~'` represents your home directory. Reload `.bashrc` after making changes.

Mini Challenge

Add permanent variables named `NAME`, `CITY` and `COURSE` to your `.bashrc` file and verify them in a new terminal.

Common Mistakes

Forgetting to save `.bashrc`, not running `source ~/.bashrc`, or adding spaces around `'='`.

Did You Know?

Many developers configure `PATH`, `JAVA_HOME` and other important settings in `.bashrc`.

Pro Tip

Keep custom environment variables grouped together in `.bashrc` with comments for easier maintenance.

Answer Key (Instructor Only)

- Q1: `nano ~/.bashrc`
Q2: `export PROJECT=linux`
Q3: `source ~/.bashrc`
Q4: `printenv PROJECT`
Q5: `echo $PROJECT`

Homework

Create three permanent environment variables and verify they still exist after opening a new terminal.

Next Day Preview

Tomorrow you'll learn how to create and use aliases to simplify frequently used Linux commands.